

SOP: BILLING ISSUE RESOLUTION

Document ID	SOP-02
Version	2.0
Effective Date	10/2/2026
Department	Call Center Operations

Applies to: All Tier 1 agents. Tier 1 handles disputes up to \$200. Fraud routes directly to Tier 2.

Steps

Step 1: Open Call & Verify Identity

Precondition	Call connected.
Action	Deliver greeting, recording notification, and 3-of-5 verification. No billing data may be accessed before verification.
Output	Customer verified.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-001, CS-RULE-002, CS-RULE-004, CS-RULE-005

Step 2: Acknowledge & Apply A.C.E.S.

Precondition	Verification complete.
Action	Apply A.C.E.S. before opening the bill: Acknowledge the concern, Clarify you will review together, Empathize, then proceed to Solve. Do not jump directly to the bill without acknowledgment.
Output	Customer acknowledged. Tension reduced.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011

Step 3: Pull Current & Previous Bill

Precondition	A.C.E.S. applied.
Action	Open both current and previous billing statements in CRM. Compare line-by-line. Identify new or changed items: one-time charges, data overage, third-party purchases, expired promotions, proration from a plan change.
Output	Discrepancy identified or charge confirmed as expected.
Policy Ref	KB-PROD-01 Section 3.1

Step 4: Explain the Charge

Precondition	Charge identified.
Action	Explain using plain language. Approved explanations: Proration — 'Because your plan changed on [date], you were charged [X]% of the old plan and [X]% of the new plan for that

	month.' Promotion Expired — 'The \$[X] discount was part of a promotion that ended this billing cycle.' Data Overage — 'Your plan includes [X]GB of high-speed data. Once used, additional data is billed at the overage rate.' Tax vs. Surcharge — 'Taxes are government-mandated; surcharges are carrier fees for regulatory recovery.' Forbidden: 'That is our policy' or 'There is nothing I can do.'
Output	Customer understands the charge.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-012

Step 5: Determine Validity

Precondition	Explanation delivered.
Action	Valid charge: explain clearly; offer alternative bundles if appropriate. Billing error (system error, double charge, failed promotion): proceed to Step 6. Disputed but valid, customer refuses after 3 identical explanations: escalate to Tier 3.
Output	Charge status confirmed as valid, error, or circular dispute.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-011, FIN-RULE-001

Step 6: Apply Credit if Error Confirmed

Precondition	Error confirmed.
Action	Apply 100% reversal of erroneous amount. If error caused service suspension, add goodwill credit. Verify authorization limit: Tier 1 max = \$25. If error exceeds \$25, submit Credit Approval Request to Tier 2/3 before communicating any amount.
Output	Credit applied, or escalation submitted.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-004, FIN-RULE-005

Step 7: Check Escalation Thresholds

Precondition	Resolution attempted.
Action	Escalate if: dispute > \$200 → Tier 2. Fraud claim → Tier 2. 3rd+ call same issue → Tier 3. Legal threat → Tier 4, no further discussion.
Output	Resolved at Tier 1, or escalated.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-014

Step 8: Document & Close

Precondition	Resolution or escalation complete.
Action	Log case notes within 5 minutes: charge discussed, explanation given, credit applied if any, customer acceptance or dispute status. Provide case reference number and offer post-call survey.
Output	Case notes saved. Call closed.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-020, CS-RULE-021, CS-RULE-022

Key Rules

- Always explain the charge before offering credit — most disputes resolve with a clear explanation.
- Never offer a proactive credit to avoid explaining a valid charge.
- Check promotion end dates first — expired promotions are the most common billing dispute source.
- Bundle/Quad-Play inquiry during billing calls is a retention opportunity. (KB-PROD-01 Section 6.3)